

Study Guide for ENGLISH 1102-01: English Composition II - Unit 6

Overview

Unit 6 of ENGLISH 1102-01 focuses on the research process, emphasizing data analysis, reporting results, and effective communication in formal settings. The readings explore scientific research methods in behavioral sciences and guidelines for writing formal reports. Key topics include understanding research methods, selecting appropriate methods, and crafting clear, professional communication to convey findings. This unit equips students with skills to analyze data, draw conclusions, and communicate results effectively in academic and professional contexts.

Guiding Questions

Consider these questions while reviewing the materials:

1. What are research methods?
2. How does one determine the suitable method?
3. What are various methods of communication in a formal setting?
4. How can communication be made more effective?
5. What are the benefits of effective communications?

Summarized Readings

1. Serdikoff, S. (2021). *Research Methods for the Behavioral Sciences* [PDF]. (5th Edition). GALILEO Open Learning Materials.

Link: [Access via GALILEO Open Learning Materials](#)

Relevant Sections: Chapter 3 (Overview of the Scientific Process), Section 16 (Analyzing the Data), Section 17 (Drawing Conclusions and Reporting the Results)

- **Key Focus:** Provides an overview of the scientific research process, with emphasis on data analysis and reporting findings in behavioral sciences.
- **Main Points:**

- **Research Methods:** Systematic approaches to investigate questions, including experimental, correlational, and observational methods. These methods involve forming hypotheses, collecting data, and testing predictions.
- **Section 16 – Analyzing the Data:** Involves statistical techniques to interpret data (e.g., descriptive statistics like means and standard deviations, inferential statistics like t-tests). Data analysis ensures results are reliable and meaningful.
- **Section 17 – Drawing Conclusions and Reporting Results:** Conclusions are drawn by comparing results to hypotheses. Reporting involves clear, structured formats (e.g., APA-style papers) with sections like introduction, methods, results, and discussion. Clarity and precision are critical for credibility.
- **Choosing Methods:** Select methods based on research goals, feasibility, and ethical considerations. For example, experiments test causality, while correlational studies explore relationships.
- **Digestible Takeaway:** Research methods are structured ways to answer questions. Analyze data with stats, report clearly in formal formats, and choose methods that fit your question and resources.

2. College of Business and Economics. (2024). *Guidelines for Reports*. Boise State University.

Link: [Access via Boise State University](#)

- **Key Focus:** Offers practical guidelines for writing formal reports, emphasizing clear communication of data-driven insights.
- **Main Points:**
 - **Structure:** Formal reports include title page, abstract, introduction, methodology, results, discussion, conclusions, and recommendations. Each section serves a specific purpose (e.g., results present data; discussion interprets it).
 - **Clarity and Conciseness:** Use clear language, avoid jargon, and present data visually (e.g., tables, graphs). Tailor content to the audience (e.g., executives need summaries, technical readers need details).
 - **Effective Communication:** Organize content logically, use headings, and ensure accuracy. Proofread to eliminate errors. Include actionable recommendations based on findings.
 - **Formal Communication Methods:** Written reports, presentations, and executive summaries. Each requires professionalism, precision, and audience awareness.
- **Digestible Takeaway:** Write formal reports with a clear structure, concise language, and audience-focused content. Use visuals and proofread to enhance communication.

Answers to Guiding Questions

1. **What are research methods?** Research methods are systematic processes to investigate questions, involving hypothesis formation, data collection, and analysis. Examples include experiments (testing causality), correlational studies (exploring relationships), and observational studies (describing behaviors).
2. **How does one determine the suitable method?** Choose methods based on the research question, goals, resources, and ethics. For example, use experiments for causal questions, surveys for opinions, or observations for natural behaviors. Feasibility and validity are key.
3. **What are various methods of communication in a formal setting?** Methods include written reports (e.g., APA-style papers, business reports), presentations, executive summaries, and memos. Each requires clear structure, professional tone, and audience adaptation.
4. **How can communication be made more effective?** Use clear, concise language; organize content logically with headings; include visuals (e.g., charts); tailor to the audience; and proofread for accuracy. Active listening and feedback improve oral communication.
5. **What are the benefits of effective communications?** Enhances understanding, builds credibility, supports decision-making, fosters collaboration, and ensures findings are actionable. Effective communication prevents misinterpretation and strengthens professional impact.

Checklist for Unit 6

- **Readings:** Review Serdikoff (Chapter 3, Sections 16–17) for research processes and Boise State guidelines for report writing.
- **Activities:** Engage in Discussion Forum (discuss research methods or communication strategies).
- **Assessments:** Complete any assigned quizzes or writing tasks (e.g., draft a report section).
- **Reflection:** Journal how research methods and communication skills apply to academic or professional work.
- **Due Dates:** Check Moodle for deadlines (typically Wednesdays at 11:55 PM GMT-5; use [UoPeople clock](#)).

Additional Tips for Study

- **Make It Digestible:** Break readings into sections; note key terms like “hypothesis,” “data analysis,” and “report structure.”

- **Connect Concepts:** Link research methods to prior units on writing or critical thinking.
- **Resources:** Access full texts via [GALILEO](#) and [Boise State](#). Review examples of APA reports or business reports online.
- **Create Your PDF:** Copy this guide into a LaTeX editor (e.g., Overleaf), compile to PDF, and add images (e.g., report structure diagrams) if desired.

This guide condenses Unit 6 into key insights for efficient review. For further details or expansions, refer to the linked resources or contact your instructor via [UoPeople Moodle](#).